



AFTER

The Battle of Chickamauga proved to be a bloody Confederate tactical victory that temporarily shifted the course of the Civil War in the Western Theater.

BRAGG AND ROSECRANS STUNNED

Rosecrans **had escaped destruction** and now lay behind Chattanooga's fortifications. Both Longstreet and Nathan Bedford Forrest urged Bragg to move at once against the Union forces before they could recover, but the Confederate commander was **as stunned in victory as Rosecrans was in defeat**. Incredulous about his superior's inertia, Forrest asked, "What does he fight battles for?" In the weeks to come the **strategic fruits of Chickamauga** slipped away into an exhausting **siege of Chattanooga** (see [The Chattanooga Campaign](#)), which the Confederates were ill-equipped to undertake. As for Rosecrans, Lincoln wrote that he behaved "**confused and stunned** like a duck hit on the head."

CHATTANOOGA UNDER SIEGE

Rosecrans found himself and his army in an unusual situation after Chickamauga: a Union army occupying a Southern city **besieged by a Confederate army**. By October, food was running out for the Union troops, and Bragg had cut off all but one **fragile supply line** across the Cumberland Mountains. If Rosecrans were to surrender, **Union momentum would have stalled considerably**.